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BILL OF RIGHTS DAY, 1946

December 9, 1946
[No. 2713]

BY THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

A PROCLAMATION

WHEREAS December 15, 1946, marks the one hundred and fifty-fifth anniversary of the adoption of the Bill of Rights; and

WHEREAS that covenant, which was written into our Constitution by the first ten amendments, guarantees to the American people freedom of religion, freedom of speech and assembly, and freedom to petition for the redress of grievances; and

WHEREAS the preservation of these inestimable privileges can be guaranteed only by courage, determination, and unremitting vigilance; and

WHEREAS it is fitting that we should set aside a day for solemn contemplation of our liberties and of the recent world-wide battle to protect them from annihilation:

Designation of Dec. 15, 1946, as Bill of Rights Day.
60 Stat. 229.

NOW, THEREFORE, I, HARRY S. TRUMAN, President of the United States of America, pursuant to a joint resolution of the Congress approved May 29, 1946, do hereby designate December 15, 1946, as Bill of Rights Day. And I call upon the officials of the Government to display the flag of the United States on all Government buildings on that day; and urge the people of the United States to observe the day with appropriate ceremonies and prayer at their homes, in schools, and in places of congregation and of worship.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto set my hand and caused the seal of the United States of America to be affixed.

DONE at the City of Washington this 9th day of December in the year of our Lord nineteen hundred and forty-six, and of the [SEAL] Independence of the United States of America the one hundred and seventy-first.

HARRY S TRUMAN

By the President
DEAN ACHESON
Acting Secretary of State

CESSATION OF HOSTILITIES OF WORLD WAR II

December 31, 1946
[No. 2714]

BY THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

A PROCLAMATION

With God's help this nation and our allies, through sacrifice and devotion, courage and perseverance, wrung final and unconditional surrender from our enemies. Thereafter, we, together with the other United Nations, set about building a world in which justice shall replace force. With spirit, through faith, with a determination that there shall be no more wars of aggression calculated to enslave the peoples of the world and destroy their civilization, and with the guidance of Almighty Providence great gains have been made in translating military victory into permanent peace. Although a state of war still exists, it is at this time possible to declare, and I find it to be in the public interest to declare, that hostilities have terminated.

Proclamation of cessation of hostilities of World War II.

NOW, THEREFORE, I, HARRY S. TRUMAN, President of the United States of America, do hereby proclaim the cessation of hostilities of World War II, effective twelve o'clock noon, December 31, 1946.